



### Facebook to hide likes?

Starting with Australia, Facebook is starting to hide like counts on posts. Authors will still see the counts. <https://digit.in/oct19-67>



### Micron reports sales decline

Micron stocks dropped by 6% after reporting a \$7 Billion drop in yearly revenue. <https://digit.in/oct19-68>

# ASUS ROG Rapture GT-AC2900 Gaming Router

## More features than you can count

**G**aming routers are in a league of their own. Plenty of hardware vendors claim to have gaming routers but they're barely earning the right to call themselves gaming routers and then, there's the ASUS GT-AC2900 which packs in more gaming related features than one will ever use in their lives.

### Design

The ASUS ROG RAPTURE GT-AC2900 is a dual-band AC router with 750 Mbps on the 2.4 GHz band (40 Hz, 1024QAM) and 2167 Mbps on the 5 GHz band (80 Hz, 1024QAM). It's based on the Broadcom BCM4906 and has a 256 MiB Macronix NAND chip and 512 MB of RMA courtesy of a Micron MT-41K256M16TW. For the WLAN1, it makes use of the Broadcom BCM4366E and follows that up with the BCM4365E for the WLAN2 chip. This particular configuration is not the first to be seen among ASUS routers. Their RT-AC86U, which is also a gaming router, came out with this configuration about two years ago and the GT-AC2900 is an upgrade over the same. In fact, the FCC filings are also the same. The key change is with the firmware and the new software integrations that we'll get to later on.

ASUS has taken the opportunity to incorporate a little RGB love into the unit as well. It even comes with a dedicated button on the side to switch the RGB colour patterns. The unit comes with a stand that can either be mounted on the bottom or the rear. In the latter configuration, you can mount it on a wall. On the rear, we see all the ports (4x LAN, 1x WAN, 1x USB 2.0, 1x USB 3.0). One of the LAN



Price  
₹22,900



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ports is dedicated for QoS, so whichever client is connected to that one gets first priority.

### Features

The GT-AC2900 claims to have triple-level game acceleration – a dedicated LAN port with priority, software QoS for video games and a specialised VPN for games (WTFast). The WTFast access is free for life for one device, so that's a good perk. The UI has a really good visualisation for ping values to popular game servers, so if you're figuring out which server to join then you might want to check the Game Radar section. You can also manually add games whose packets need to be prioritised by the router.

Aside from the dedicated gaming features, the GT-AC2900 also comes with simple bandwidth and traffic monitoring tools. Yes, you can check what everyone else is browsing using this router. Then there's Wi-Fi Site survey to list all SSIDs in the vicinity, AiMesh to form your own

mesh network with other compatible routers. It even has Alexa integration. You can use an Alexa-enabled device to make the router perform actions. All you need is an Alexa/Echo device with the 'ASUS Router' skill installed. Lastly, it's got GeForce Now certification which is a good thing to have but NVIDIA's yet to launch it in India.

### Performance

We decided to test out the QoS by running a lot of high-bandwidth TCP+UDP connections (read – we downloaded a lot of stuff and had videos streaming simultaneously) and then observed ping values within World of Tanks to their ASIA server. The values were consistent regardless of the background traffic aside from the occasional anomaly. Then we checked to see if WTFast was indeed helpful. It didn't help with World of Tanks but it improved our ping in Overwatch. This varies from ISP to ISP and we noticed the same as we switched between the three leased lines that we have. Lastly, we ran our usual set of bandwidth tests and scored 498 Mbps downlink on the 2.4 GHz band and around 313 Mbps on the uplink. On the 5 GHz band, both uplink and downlink was around 930 Mbps. The former isn't at the top of the charts but the latter is more consistent with other routers's 5 GHz bands.

### Verdict

The ASUS ROG RAPTURE GT-AC2900 is easily the most feature laden router we've come across. It has easily earned the right to call itself a gaming router. The only thing holding it back is that fact that it's dual band but the 1024QAM makes up for it. Overall, this is a router that prosumers would love to own.

–Mithun Mohandas

### SPECIFICATIONS

SOC: Broadcom BCM4906 | WLAN1: BCM4366E | WLAN2: BCM4365E | LAN: 4x Gigabit Ethernet | WAN: 1x Gigabit Ethernet | ANTENNAE: 1x Internal, 3x External | WPS: Yes | PROTOCOLS: 802.11ac (2900 Mbps).

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